

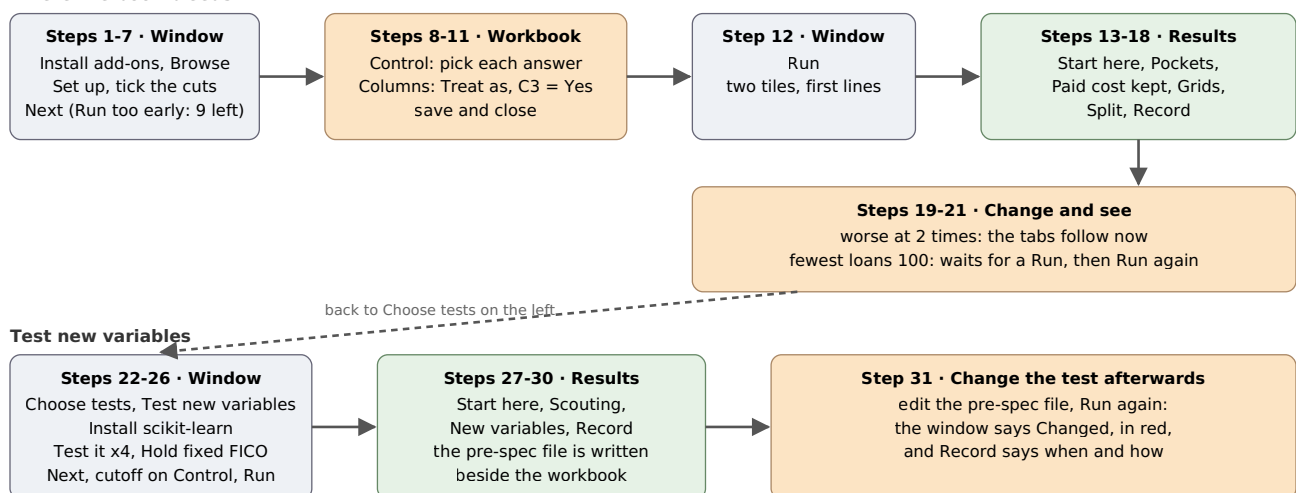
PocketBook, step by step: finding where a loan book bleeds, and testing a new variable

Who this is for: an analyst using PocketBook for the first time. You need the loan file from the bank and Excel. You don't type any commands.

What you'll have at the end: a workbook beside the loan file that shows which groups of loans lose more than their share, how much, and whether it could be chance. Then a second kind of run: whether a new column (here, revolving debt) really tells good loans from bad, checked on loans it was never found on.

Walked on: 27 Sep 2026, on a made-up book of 8,000 loans with known answers planted in it. The whole walk was taken again on 28 Sep 2026, on the same book, after two changes: Choose tests now lists the columns in the order you work down them, and the tree is the main path for a new variable (a cutoff date you pick, the tree checked on the loans after it, the shortlist tested together). Every picture below is the real screen from that second walk.

Where the book bleeds



Grey: the PocketBook window. Peach: where you answer (Excel, or the pre-spec file). Green: where you read the results.
Nothing is typed at a command line. Step 32 is what a Run that stops looks like.

The route: the window, the workbook, the window again, then the results, for each kind of run.

Words you'll meet

Each is shown the first time on screen. This is what they mean.

On screen	What it means
Extract	The loan file from the bank: one row per loan, as a .csv or .xlsx. PocketBook never changes it.
Workbook	The Excel file PocketBook writes beside the extract. You answer questions in it, and the results land in it.
Band	A range of a number column, like a FICO score from 496 to 653. Cut into bands means split the column into ranges.
Segment	A group from a category column, like the Broker channel.
Pocket	

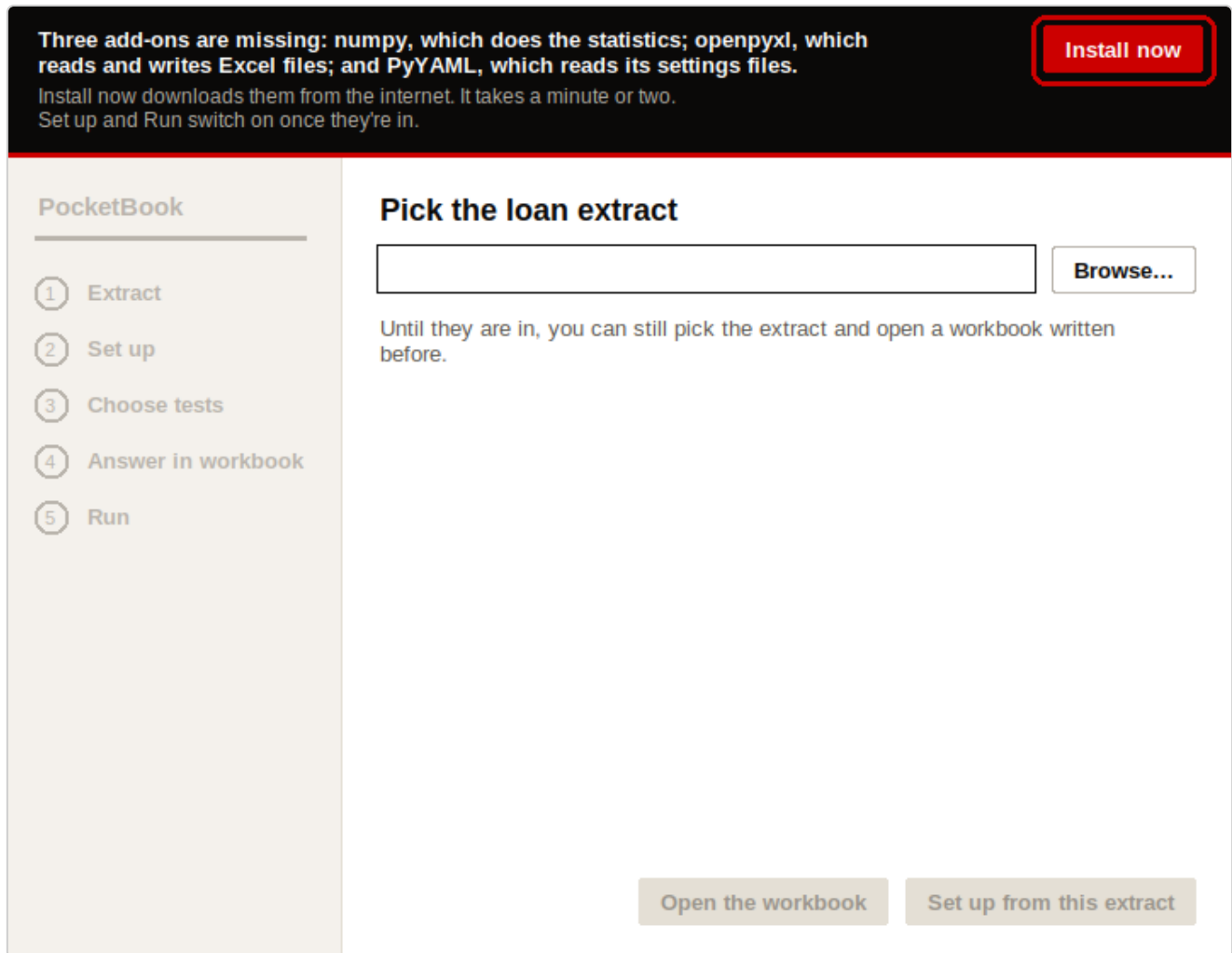
On screen	What it means
	One band crossed with one segment: FICO 496 to 653 and Broker. The thing PocketBook judges.
Grid	Every band of one column against every segment of another: one table of pockets.
GCO	Gross charge-offs: the dollars written off on loans that went bad. On screen as Charge-offs .
RANR	What the bank kept after losses: interest and fees, less the cost of funds, less charge-offs. On screen as Kept after losses .
Worse at 1.34x	A pocket counts as worse when it goes bad at least 1.34 times as often as the loans it is compared with.
p-value	How likely a gap this big is by chance alone. Under 5% means it is unlikely to be chance.
Material	Big enough in dollars to matter: at or above the line you pick on Control.
Pre-spec	A short file that fixes, before the test, exactly what will be tested. It stops anyone moving the goalposts after seeing the answer.
Cutoff	A date you pick on Control. Loans made before it are where an idea is found (development). Loans made on or after it are held back and only used to check it.
Scouting	The step where a tree of yes/no questions looks through the columns you ticked, on the development loans, and proposes which are worth testing.
AUC	How well a score puts bad loans above good ones: 0.5 is a coin flip, 1 is perfect.

Part A · Open PocketBook

Step 1 · Double-click PocketBook.pyw

The window opens with five steps down the left. The first time, a black bar may say some add-ons are missing. **Add-ons** are free pieces of software PocketBook needs to do its sums and read Excel.

Press **Install now**.



Correct screen: the bar names what is missing and what each one does. **Set up** is grey until they're in.

Step 2 · Pick the extract

Press **Browse...**, find the loan file, and press **Open**.

Three add-ons are missing: numpy, which does the statistics; openpyxl, which reads and writes Excel files; and PyYAML, which reads its settings files.

Install now downloads them from the internet. It takes a minute or two.
Set up and Run switch on once they're in.

Install now

PocketBook

Pick the loan extract

- 1 Extract
- 2 Set up
- 3 Choose tests
- 4 Answer in workb
- 5 Run

Directory: /srv/analyst/Loan files 

Consumer book Q3.csv

File name: Consumer book Q3.csv 

Files of type: Extracts (*.csv,*.xlsx) 

workbook written

Open the workbook

Set up from this extract

Step 3 · Wait for the install

It takes a minute or two (a few seconds if the add-ons were fetched before).

PocketBook

1 Extract

Pick the loan file

2 Set up

3 Choose tests

4 Answer in workbook

5 Run

Pick the loan extract

One row per loan, as a .csv or .xlsx. Set up reads it and guesses what each column means. The workbook is written beside it once you've chosen the tests. The extract itself is never changed.

/srv/analyst/Loan files/Consumer book Q3.csv

Browse...

▼ How Set up recognises columns

A number column with this many values or fewer is a category

12 values ▼

A text column with more values than this is too fine to cut by

50 values ▼

Installed numpy, openpyxl and PyYAML. Everything PocketBook needs is here.

Set up from this extract

Correct screen: the black bar has gone. A line says what was installed. **Set up from this extract** is red, so you can press it. The two settings under How Set up recognises columns can be left as they are.

Part B · Where the book bleeds

Step 4 · Press Set up from this extract

PocketBook reads the file and guesses what each column is. Nothing is written yet.

PocketBook

- ✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv - 8,000 loans
- ✓ **Set up**
10 columns read
- 3 Choose tests**
Where the book bleeds
- 4 Answer in workbook
- 5 Run

What are you running?

Where the book bleeds Test new variables

Column	What it is	Cut into bands	Segment by	Split by
FICO	FICO score	✓		☐
ORIG_BAL	Booked amount	✓		☐
REV_DEBT	Amount or number	✓		☐
CHANNEL	Category - 3 values		✓	
ASSET_CLASS	Category - 4 values		✓	
BAD_FLAG	Outcome (yes/no)			
GCO_AMT	GCO dollars			
RANR_AMT	RANR dollars			
LOAN_NBR	Loan number (key)			
ORIG_DATE	Origination date			

This will run: 3 band columns × 2 segment columns = 6 grids, five measures each.

GCO dollars: what a loan charged off, in dollars.
RANR dollars: what we kept from a loan after its losses, in dollars.
A grid: every band of one column against every segment of another.
Five measures: bad loans, bad dollars, charge-offs, earned before and kept after losses.

Saved to Control, read-only.

Next: answer in the workbook →

Correct screen: the left side shows the file name and "8,000 loans", then "10 columns read". The table lists every column with what PocketBook thinks it is: the number columns first, then the categories, then the outcome and dollar columns, then the loan number and date in grey. **Where the book bleeds** is picked at the top right.

The boxes decide what is cut:

- **Cut into bands:** number columns to split into ranges (FICO, ORIG_BAL, REV_DEBT are ticked).
- **Segment by:** category columns (CHANNEL, ASSET_CLASS).
- **Split by:** at most one number column, used to cut every pocket in half at its own middle value.
- The outcome and dollar columns have no boxes: they are what is measured, not what is cut.

In the shaded box, under what will run, a line for each word you meet here first: GCO dollars, RANR dollars, a grid, and the five measures.

The made-up book has three number columns you can cut. Your bank's file may have more.

Step 5 · Tick Split by on REV_DEBT

Press the round button in the **Split by** column on the REV_DEBT row.

PocketBook

- ✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans
- ✓ **Set up**
10 columns read
- 3 Choose tests**
Where the book bleeds
- 4 Answer in workbook
- 5 Run

What are you running?

Where the book bleeds | Test new variables

Column	What it is	Cut into bands	Segment by	Split by
FICO	FICO score	☒		☐
ORIG_BAL	Booked amount	☒		☐
REV_DEBT	Amount or number	☐		☒
CHANNEL	Category · 3 values		☒	
ASSET_CLASS	Category · 4 values		☒	
BAD_FLAG	Outcome (yes/no)			
GCO_AMT	GCO dollars			
RANR_AMT	RANR dollars			
LOAN_NBR	Loan number (key)			
ORIG_DATE	Origination date			

This will run: 2 band columns × 2 segment columns = 4 grids, five measures each; split by REV_DEBT adds 4 more.

GCO dollars: what a loan charged off, in dollars.
RANR dollars: what we kept from a loan after its losses, in dollars.
A grid: every band of one column against every segment of another.
Five measures: bad loans, bad dollars, charge-offs, earned before and kept after losses.

Saved to Control, read-only.

Next: answer in the workbook →

Correct screen: REV_DEBT's **Cut into bands** box clears by itself (a column can't be both). The shaded box under the table says what will run: 2 band columns × 2 segment columns = 4 grids ... split by REV_DEBT adds 4 more.

Step 6 · Press Next: answer in the workbook

The workbook is written beside the extract: Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook.xlsx.

PocketBook

- ✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv - 8,000 loans
- ✓ **Set up**
10 columns read
- ✓ **Choose tests**
Where the book bleeds
- 4** **Answer in workbook**
Fill in the shaded cells
- 5 **Run**

Answer in the workbook

Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook.xlsx is written beside the extract. Fill in the shaded cells, save and close it, then press Run.

Worked out from this extract: fewest loans 65; worse at 1.34x; better at 0.75x. Each sits beside its setting on Control, for you to take or not.

worse at 1.34x: losing 1.34 times as much as the rest counts as worse.
better at 0.75x: losing 0.75 times as much as the rest counts as better.

Next: 9 answers needed before Run, on Control and Columns. Fill in the shaded cells, save, close, and press Run.

Open the workbook

Run

Correct screen: step 4 on the left is red. The shaded box gives three values PocketBook worked out from this book (fewest loans in a pocket, how much worse, how much better), with a line under it on what worse at and better at mean. They are only suggestions, and each sits beside its question on the Control tab. Under the box: **9 answers needed before Run, on Control and Columns**. Start here and the Run itself (Step 7) give the same count.

Step 7 · (What happens if you press Run too early)

If you press **Run** now, nothing runs. The window lists every answer still needed, with the tab and cell.

PocketBook

- ✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv -
8,000 loans
- ✓ **Set up**
10 columns read
- ✓ **Choose tests**
Where the book bleeds
- ! **Answer in workbook**
9 left
- 5 **Run**

9 answers needed before Run

Each one opens the workbook at its cell. Nothing ran; your answers so far are kept.

CONTROL C15 How much worse than its comparison a pocket must be	<button>Open at C15</button>
CONTROL C16 How much better than its comparison a pocket must be	<button>Open at C16</button>
CONTROL C17 How far profit must move before it counts as more or less	<button>Open at C17</button>
CONTROL C18 How sure a difference must be before it counts	<button>Open at C18</button>
CONTROL C19 Smallest excess loss worth reporting	<button>Open at C19</button>
CONTROL C20 What a pocket is judged against	<button>Open at C20</button>
CONTROL C24 Fewest loans in a pocket for the usual test (smaller ones get the exact test)	<button>Open at C24</button>

Open the workbook
Run

[illegible]

[illegible]

Step 9 · Answer Control

Question	Answer picked	Why
How much worse than its comparison a pocket must be	The smallest significant gap in a typical pocket (suggested)	comes to 1.34 times, worked out from this book
How much better ...	The smallest significant gap in a typical pocket (suggested)	0.75 times
How far profit must move before it counts	Each pocket's own test (suggested)	
How sure a difference must be before it counts	95% sure	
Smallest excess loss worth reporting	1% of the book's total losses	comes to \$107,354 once the Run has added up the book's losses
What a pocket is judged against	The rest of its band	
Fewest loans in a pocket for the usual test	Enough for 5 expected losses (suggested)	65 loans
Fewest loans with a loss before a loss rate is tested	10 losses	

PocketBook

✓ Extract

Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans

✓ Set up

10 columns read

✓ Choose tests

Where the book bleeds

4 Answer in workbook

Fill in the shaded cells

5 Run

Answer in the workbook

Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook.xlsx is written beside the extract. Fill in the shaded cells, save and close it, then press Run.

The workbook is open in Excel.
Save and close it first, so Run reads your latest answers.

Worked out from this extract: fewest loans 65; worse at 1.34x; better at 0.75x. Each sits beside its setting on Control, for you to take or not.
worse at 1.34x: losing 1.34 times as much as the rest counts as worse.
better at 0.75x: losing 0.75 times as much as the rest counts as better.

Next: 9 answers needed before Run, on Control and Columns. Fill in the shaded cells, save, close, and press Run.

Open the workbookRun

Correct screen after closing: the pink bar goes by itself within a couple of seconds, and **Run** turns red.

Step 12 · Press Run

On 8,000 loans it took 10 seconds.

PocketBook

✓ Extract

Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans

✓ Set up

10 columns read

✓ Choose tests

Where the book bleeds

✓ Answer in workbook

All answered

✓ Run

01:47 · 10 seconds

Run finished. Results are in the workbook.

Pockets worse and material

4

charge-offs, of 81

Charge-offs above their share

\$3.09M

in those 4 pockets

Open Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook.xlsx: start with Pockets. Split by REV_DEBT: each pocket halved at its own median. See the Split tab, and Pockets split by REV_DEBT. REV_DEBT isn't cut on its own while it splits.

Run again

Open at Start here

Correct screen: "Run finished." Two tiles: how many pockets are worse on charge-offs and material, and the charge-off dollars above their share in them. Under them, the Run's first two lines: where to start reading, and what splits the pockets. PocketBook also checks that every grid adds back up to the book. If one didn't, the Run would stop there and say so (Step 32); Record keeps how many checks there were.

Step 13 · Read Start here

Press **Open at Start here**.

PocketBook

Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans · 10 columns · last Run 2026-09-28 01:47

How this tab works

Where things stand

What is left before Run, counted live from Control and Columns as you fill them in.

What the last Run found

Pockets worse and material at Control's lines, and the five largest.

The tabs

Red tabs you fill in; black tabs hold results; grey tabs are the record.

WHERE THINGS STAND

Answers needed before Run	Odd values to answer	Changes waiting for a Run
0	0	0
Control and Columns	Columns · Treat as	Control · Status

WHAT THE LAST RUN FOUND

Pockets worse and material, charge-offs	Dollars above their share, in those	Pockets keeping less, worse and material
4 of 81	\$3,094,991	4 short \$3,248,654

Largest, worse and material	Segment	Loans	× its comparison	Dollars above share
FICO 496 - 653	Broker	523	2.62×	\$1,494,129
FICO 496 - 653	ASSET_CLASS 4	392	1.74×	\$643,768
ORIG_BAL 37,951 - 49,151	ASSET_CLASS 4	414	1.75×	\$529,198
FICO 712 - 745	Online	564	2.06×	\$427,896

Every pocket, every measure: the Pockets tab.

THE TABS

You answer	Results	Record
Control: the professional calls	Pockets: every pocket, worse first	Record: what ran, the tie-outs, every Run
Columns: meanings, odd values, memory	Paid, cost, kept: paid against cost	
Look: each number column's shape	Grids: one grid at a time, and how common	
	Split: each pocket halved	

Correct screen: Where things stand is all zeros: no answers needed before Run, no odd value left, no change waiting. **What the last Run found** gives the same numbers as the window, then the largest pockets that are worse and material. On the walk the top one was FICO 496 to 653 / Broker, 2.62 times its band's charge-offs, \$1,494,129 above its share. That is the pocket planted in the made-up book.

Step 14 · Read Pockets

Every pocket, worst first. Pick the **Measure** (Bad loans, Bad dollars, Charge-offs, Kept after losses, Earned before losses), **Pockets** (two-way, or split) and **Show** at the top.

Pockets

Which pockets lose more than their share, how much, and whether it's real and big enough to matter.

How this tab works

A pocket

One band of one column crossed with one segment of another, in every grid chosen in the launcher. Loans: how many are in it. Split by REV_DEBT: each pocket halved at its own median REV_DEBT, each half tested like any other pocket.

Rest of band

Every other loan in the same band, judged against on Control picks it or the rest of the book (every other loan in the book); now the rest of its band. It decides the gap, the excess and both verdicts. A pocket alone in its band has nothing beside it to compare with, so it is judged against the rest of the book, whatever Control says.

Excess

What the pocket lost above what it would have lost at the rest's rate: bad loans for Bad loans, dollars for the dollar measures. For Kept after losses and Earned before losses, the dollars it fell short of the rest, and the gap is in points of booked dollars.

Worse?

Yes: at least 1.34x the rest (for profit, short of it by the profit line on Control), with a p-value under 5%. Not sure: the gap is there, but the p-value isn't under it. Too few losses: fewer than 10 (a setting for the next Run), so not tested. No: anything else.

p-value

The chance of a gap at least this big if the pocket were no different from the rest, after the allowance for testing many pockets at once (Benjamini-Hochberg, across one grid and one measure). Bad loans: the z test, or the exact test for a pocket under 65 loans. Dollar measures: the loans are shuffled 10,000 times, within the band for the rest of its band, and it is how often a gap as big turned up. Under 5% counts.

Material?

Yes when the excess reaches the materiality line on Control (the Material at tile, in the measure's own unit). It is judged apart from Worse?: a pocket can be one without the other.

Could have caught

The smallest gap a pocket this size would catch 80% of the time at the last Run's confidence. As of the last Run.

Order

Sorted as of the last Run: worse pockets first, largest excess first, then the rest by their excess. Last come pockets losing more only against the other comparison, so that changing judged against on Control finds them here. A change on Control updates Worse?, Material?, the dollars and the colours at once, not the order. The caption counts what the dropdowns pick.

Holds FICO fixed?

Split only. REV_DEBT moves with FICO (correlation -0.53), so a split pocket in a grid that doesn't hold FICO fixed may be showing FICO, not REV_DEBT. Those rows come last, in grey, with no verdict colour.

LINES IN USE NOW

Worse at

Better at

How sure

Material at

Judged against

live from Control

1.34×

0.75×

95%

6.2 bad loans

Rest of its band

Order and "Could have caught" are from the last Run, 2026-09-28 01:47.

MEASURE

POCKETS

SHOW

Bad loans

Two-way

All

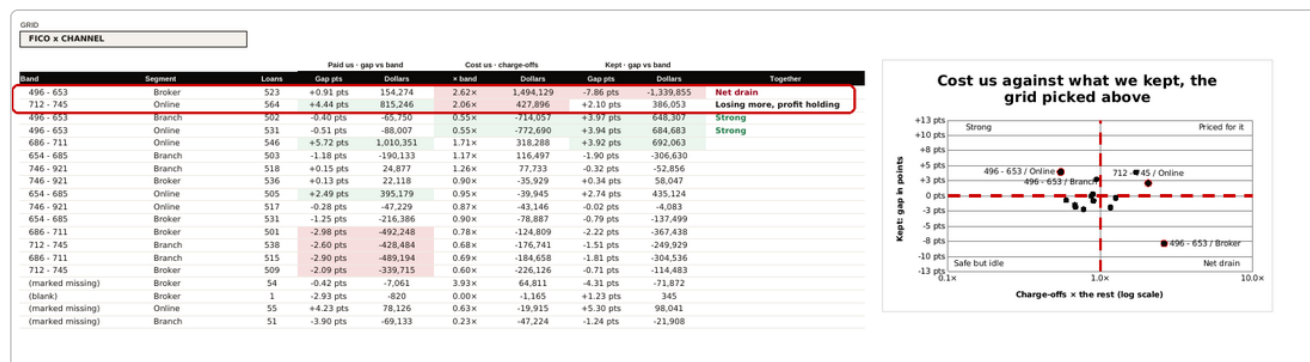
7 worse and material · 7 worse · 41 shown

#	Band	Segment	Loans	This pocket	Rest of band	× rest of band	Bad loans above share	Worse?	p-value	Material?	Could have caught
1	FICO 496 - 653	Broker	523	24.47%	10.27%	2.38×	74.3	Yes	under 0.01%	Yes	1.46×
2	FICO 712 - 745	Online	564	8.69%	3.63%	2.39×	28.5	Yes	0.02%	Yes	1.45×
3	FICO 496 - 653	ASSET_CLASS 4	392	20.41%	13.24%	1.54×	28.1	Yes	1.4%	Yes	1.54×
4	ORIG_BAL 37,951 - 49,151	ASSET_CLASS 4	414	12.32%	7.00%	1.76×	22.0	Yes	1.5%	Yes	1.52×
5	FICO 654 - 685	ASSET_CLASS 4	410	11.71%	7.26%	1.61×	18.2	Yes	4.5%	Yes	1.52×
6	ORIG_BAL 26,324 - 37,950	ASSET_CLASS 4	412	9.95%	5.82%	1.71×	17.0	Yes	4.3%	Yes	1.52×
7	FICO 712 - 745	ASSET_CLASS 4	427	8.20%	4.39%	1.87×	16.2	Yes	3.4%	Yes	1.51×
8	ORIG_BAL 15,449 - 26,323	Broker	537	11.73%	8.09%	1.45×	19.6	Not sure	11.0%	Yes	1.46×
9	ORIG_BAL 49,152 - 59,984	Broker	520	8.46%	5.46%	1.55×	15.6	Not sure	11.0%	Yes	1.47×
10	FICO 686 - 711	Online	546	7.69%	5.31%	1.45×	13.0	Not sure	16.0%	Yes	1.46×
11	ORIG_BAL 15,449 - 26,323	ASSET_CLASS 4	413	11.38%	8.59%	1.32×	11.5	No	23.3%	Yes	1.52×
12	ORIG_BAL 5,005 - 15,448	ASSET_CLASS 4	425	9.65%	6.98%	1.38×	11.3	Not sure	21.9%	Yes	1.51×
13	ORIG_BAL 49,152 - 59,984	ASSET_CLASS 4	384	8.59%	5.76%	1.49×	10.9	Not sure	19.3%	Yes	1.54×
14	FICO 686 - 711	ASSET_CLASS 4	407	8.11%	5.45%	1.49×	10.8	Not sure	16.6%	Yes	1.53×
15	ORIG_BAL 37,951 - 49,151	Broker	531	9.23%	7.95%	1.16×	6.8	No	86.7%	Yes	1.46×
16	ORIG_BAL 37,951 - 49,151	ASSET_CLASS 3	382	9.69%	7.96%	1.22×	6.6	No	44.5%	Yes	1.54×
17	FICO (marked missing)	Broker	54	12.96%	2.83%	4.58×	5.5	Too few losses	9.6%	No	2.52×
18	ORIG_BAL 5,005 - 15,448	Broker	514	8.37%	7.37%	1.14×	5.1	No	86.7%	No	1.47×
19	ORIG_BAL 5,005 - 15,448	Online	544	8.27%	7.39%	1.12×	4.8	No	86.7%	No	1.46×

Correct screen: the **Lines in use now** bar repeats your Control answers. **Worse?** is Yes, Not sure (a gap, but it could be chance), Too few losses (not tested) or No. **Material?** is Yes when the excess reaches your dollar line.

Step 15 • Read Paid, cost, kept

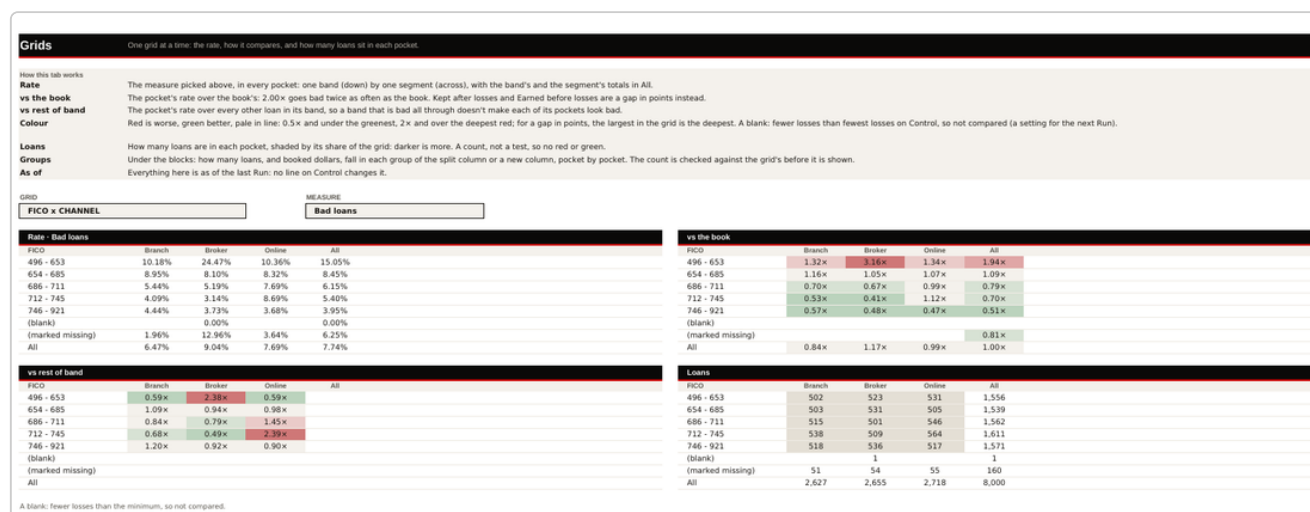
What each pocket paid the bank, what its losses cost, and what was kept. **Together** reads both sides at once: Net drain is more charge-offs and less kept; Strong is fewer charge-offs and more kept; Losing more, profit holding is more charge-offs while what was kept is about the same.



Correct screen: FICO 496 to 653 / Broker reads **Net drain**, and FICO 712 to 745 / Online **Losing more, profit holding**. The chart puts each pocket by its charge-offs (across) and what it kept (up).

Step 16 • Read Grids

One grid at a time: the rate in each pocket, the rate against the whole book, against the rest of its band, and how many loans each pocket holds. Pick the grid and measure at the top.



Step 17 • Read Split

Every pocket cut in half at its own middle REV_DEBT. Does the high half do worse?

Split

Every pocket split in two at its own median REV_DEBT: does the high half do worse?

How this tab works

What it does

Inside each pocket the loans are sorted by REV_DEBT and cut at that pocket's own median. The high half is compared with the low half, so the band and segment are the same on both sides. REV_DEBT isn't cut into bands of its own while it splits.

High vs low

The high half's rate over the low half's: 2.00x means the high half goes bad, or loses, twice as often. Kept after losses and Earned before losses are a gap in points instead: +0.30 pts means the high half keeps 0.30 points more per booked dollar.

High vs low, all

The high halves' actual total against what it would be at their low halves' rates, added over every pocket, with its range at 95% sure. For Bad loans only, the odds are pooled too (Mantel-Haenszel: a standard way to combine pockets without mixing their loans), with their p-value (Cochran-Mantel-Haenszel), and Cochran's Q asks whether the gap is the same size in every pocket.

p-value

The chance of a gap at least this big if the two halves were no different. Under 5% counts, and is bold. Bad loans: the gap in standard errors; a dollar measure: the loans dealt into the two halves at random inside their pocket, 10,000 times. The pockets are after the allowance for many tests (Benjamini-Hochberg, across one grid and one measure); a gap that is not significant is in brackets, unshaded. The summary is one pooled test per grid and measure, with no allowance. A blank: a half has fewer loans or losses than the minimums (65 loans, 10 losses).

What it holds

A grid holds fixed only its band and segment. REV_DEBT moves with FICO (correlation -0.53), so in a grid that doesn't hold FICO fixed part of every gap may be FICO, not REV_DEBT: the chip says which. Grids that hold it fixed come first in the list. Loans are treated as independent of each other.

As of

The numbers are the last Run's. The range, the brackets and the bold follow the confidence on Control.

LINES IN USE NOW

live from Control

Worse at

Better at

How sure

Material at

Judged against

The numbers are from the last Run, 2026-09-28 01:47.

1.34x

0.75x

95%

\$107,354

Rest of its band

GRID

FICO x CHANNEL

Holds FICO fixed

This grid holds FICO fixed (REV_DEBT's correlation with it: -0.53). It doesn't hold ORIG_BAL fixed (REV_DEBT's correlation with it: -0.02).

Measure	Pockets	High half worse in	High vs low, all	Range (95% sure)	p-value	As odds	p-value, as odds
Bad loans	15	14 of 15	2.02x	1.79x to 2.25x	under 0.01%	2.19x	under 0.01%
Bad dollars	15	15 of 15	2.14x	1.87x to 2.40x	under 0.01%		
Charge-offs	15	14 of 15	2.13x	1.86x to 2.41x	under 0.01%		
Kept after losses	15	13 of 15	-2.78 pts	-3.65 to -1.92 pts	under 0.01%		
Earned before losses	15	5 of 15	+0.26 pts	-0.21 to +0.72 pts	29.2%		

Same in every pocket? Bad loans: no sign the gap differs between pockets; Bad dollars, Charge-offs, Kept after losses, Earned before losses: not tested: dollar rate.

MEASURE

Bad loans

Bad loans, high vs low

	Branch	Broker	Online
496 - 653	2.39x	2.67x	(1.63x)
654 - 685	(1.37x)	2.92x	2.24x
686 - 711	(2.12x)	(1.90x)	3.20x
712 - 745	(2.14x)	(0.78x)	(1.58x)
746 - 921	(1.30x)	(2.33x)	(1.12x)
(blank)			
(marked missing)			

p-value per pocket

	Branch	Broker	Online
496 - 653	0.76%	under 0.01%	12.8%
654 - 685	33.5%	0.40%	2.9%
686 - 711	12.7%	14.3%	0.31%
712 - 745	13.6%	66.1%	14.3%
746 - 921	60.3%	12.8%	80.9%
(blank)			
(marked missing)			

Correct screen: on Bad loans, the high half is worse in 14 of 15 pockets, 2.02 times overall. The grid holds FICO fixed, which matters because REV_DEBT moves with FICO. The tab says so beside the grid.

Step 18 · Read Record

What ran, whether it adds up, what was left out, and every Run. This is the tab for a reviewer.

Record		What ran, whether it adds up, what was left out, and every Run. For the reviewer	
How this tab works		What the last Run was, whether it adds up, which tests it used, what it left out, and every Run and refusal. Nothing here is a result: the result tabs hold those.	
What it holds		Each Control setting: the answer in use now, and what the last Run used. A setting changed since the Run is shaded: the result tabs follow a Changes-now setting at once, and a Needs-a-Run one at the next Run.	
Settings		Newest first. Each entry is what that Run used, and a refusal says what it was waiting for.	
Every Run			
This Run		Settings	
Item	Detail	Setting	In use now
Extract	Consumer book Q3.csv	How many bands a number column is cut into	5 bands
Loans run	8,000	Where the band edges fall	Each band holds about the same number of loans
What was run	Where the book bleeds	Fewest loans in a pocket for the usual test (smaller ones get the exact test)	Enough for 5 expected losses (suggested)
Record of this run	Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook - what ran,yaml, beside this workbook: every setting the run used, kept for the file. It is replaced by the next Run.	Fewest loans with a loss before a loss rate is tested	10 losses
Origination dates	2021-06-30 to 2026-03-30 (8,000 loans; 0 without a readable date)	Smallest excess loss worth reporting	1.0% of the book's GCO, \$107,354
Band edges used: FICO	654; 686; 712; 746 (5 bands)	What a pocket is judged against	the rest of its band
Band edges used: ORIG_BAL	15,449; 26,324; 37,951; 49,152 (5 bands)	How much worse than its comparison a pocket must be	worse at 1.34x
Split	REV_DEBT, each pocket halved at its own median. REV_DEBT isn't cut on its own while it splits. Split pockets:	How much better than its comparison a pocket must be	better at 0.75x
	158.	How far profit must move before it counts as more or less	each pocket's own test
How closely REV_DEBT moves with FICO	correlation -0.53	How sure a difference must be before it counts	95% sure
How closely REV_DEBT moves with ORIG_BAL	correlation -0.02	How often a real gap should be caught	80% of the time
Does it add up		Tests used	
Check	Result	Where	Test
Tie-out checks	702: every grid adds up to the book	Outcome, share of loans: the z test, pooled, for a pocket of 65 loans or more, and the exact test (Fisher's) below that. Every dollar rate: the loans are shuffled 10,000 times, within the band for the rest of its band, and its p-value is how often a shuffle made a gap as big. Profit and contribution are compared as a gap in points, never a multiple. The split's odds: Cochran-Mantel-Haenszel, which asks whether an odds ratio this far from 1 could come from shuffling loans within their pockets. It has no continuity correction: nothing is taken off the gap between actual and expected before it is squared.	
Worse now: Bad loans	7 of 81 pockets on the grids read worse; 7 of them are material.	p-value	The chance of a gap at least this big if there were no real difference, after the allowance for many tests. Below 5% is significant, at 95% sure. Two-sided: a gap either way counts.
Worse now: Bad dollars	6 of 81 pockets on the grids read worse; 6 of them are material.	Standard error	How far a rate worked out from this many loans typically lands from its true value. A gap of 1.96 standard errors is the 95% line.
Worse now: Charge-offs	4 of 81 pockets on the grids read worse; 4 of them are material.	The allowance for many tests covers	each grid and measure on its own, one comparison at a time
Worse now: Kept after losses	4 of 81 pockets on the grids read worse; 4 of them are material.		
Worse now: Earned before losses	8 of 81 pockets on the grids read worse; 7 of them are material.		
Loans needed for a 1.34x gap: Bad loans	about 1,026		
Loans needed for a 1.34x gap: Bad dollars	about 1,122		
Loans needed for a 1.34x gap: Charge-offs	about 1,200		

Step 19 • Change a "Changes now" answer and watch the tabs follow

On Control, change **How much worse than its comparison a pocket must be** to **2 times**. Save.

PocketBook

Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans · 10 columns · last Run 2026-09-28 01:47

How this tab works

Where things stand

What is left before Run, counted live from Control and Columns as you fill them in.

What the last Run found

Pockets worse and material at Control's lines, and the five largest.

The tabs

Red tabs you fill in; black tabs hold results; grey tabs are the record.

WHERE THINGS STAND

Answers needed before Run

0

Odd values to answer

0

Changes waiting for a Run

0

Control and Columns

Columns - Treat as

Control - Status

WHAT THE LAST RUN FOUND

Pockets worse and material, charge-offs

2 of 81

Dollars above their share, in those

\$1,922,025

Pockets keeping less, worse and material

4 short \$3,248,654

Largest, worse and material

Segment

Loans

× its comparison

Dollars above share

FICO 496 - 653

Broker

523

2.62×

\$1,494,129

FICO 712 - 745

Online

564

2.06×

\$427,896

Every pocket, every measure: the Pockets tab.

THE TABS

You answer

Control: the professional calls

Columns: meanings, odd values, memory

Look: each number column's shape

Results

Pockets: every pocket, worse first

Paid, cost, kept: paid against cost

Grids: one grid at a time, and how common

Split: each pocket halved

Record

Record: what ran, the tie-outs, every Run

Correct screen: without pressing Run, Start here now says **2 of 81** (it said 4), and its list of the largest keeps only the two still worse: FICO 496 to 653 / Broker and FICO 712 to 745 / Online. Pockets' **Worse?** column follows. Rows now under 2 times read **No**:

LINES IN USE NOW										Order and "Could have caught" are from the last Run, 2026-09-28 01:47.			
live from Control													

How this tab works

Where things stand

What is left before Run, counted live from Control and Columns as you fill them in.

What the last Run found

Pockets worse and material at Control's lines, and the five largest.

The tabs

Red tabs you fill in; black tabs hold results; grey tabs are the record.

WHERE THINGS STAND

Answers needed before Run

Odd values to answer

Changes waiting for a Run

0

0

1

Control and Columns

Columns · Treat as

Control - Status

⚠ 1 change is waiting for a Run. Fewest loans in a pocket for the usual test (smaller ones get the exact test): Enough for 5 expected losses (suggested) → 100 loans (Control C24). The result tabs still show the last Run. Save, close, and press Run in the launcher.

WHAT THE LAST RUN FOUND

Pockets worse and material, charge-offs

Dollars above their share, in those

Pockets keeping less, worse and material

4 of 81

\$3,094,991

4 short \$3,248,654

Largest, worse and material	Segment	Loans	x its comparison	Dollars above share
FICO 496 - 653	Broker	523	2.62x	\$1,494,129
FICO 496 - 653	ASSET_CLASS 4	392	1.74x	\$643,768
ORIG_BAL 37,951 - 49,151	ASSET_CLASS 4	414	1.75x	\$529,198
FICO 712 - 745	Online	564	2.06x	\$427,896

Every pocket, every measure: the Pockets tab.

Correct screen: Start here's **Changes waiting for a Run** says 1, in red, and a pink line names the change and its cell. On Control its **Status** reads **Waiting for a Run**. The choices made in the launcher, at the foot of Control, have a Status too, and read **Same as last Run**:

It needs a Run - takes effect when you press Run again

Setting	Your answer to:	Or your own	Last Run used as reference	Suggested: 65, from this extract at the last Run	Worked out from the loans
Forecast loans in a pocket for the usual test (smaller ones get the exact test)	100 loans	65 (worked out from this book)	Same as last Run		
Forecast loans with a loss before a loss rate is applied	10 losses	10 losses	Same as last Run		
How many bands a number column is cut into	5 bands (recommended)	5 bands	Same as last Run		
Where the band edges fall	Each band holds about the same number of loans (recommended)	80% of the share (recommended)	Same as last Run		
How often a rating or flag should be caught	Hold down the share of false finds (Benjamin-Hochberg) (recommended)	80% of the time	Same as last Run		
Allowing for testing many pockets at once		Hold down the share of false finds (Benjamin-Hochberg)	Same as last Run		

Chosen in the launcher - read-only here

What are you running?	Where the book bleeds	Some as last Run
Cut into bands	FICO, ORIG_BAL	Same as last Run
Segment by	CHANNEL, ASSET_CLASS	Same as last Run
Spilt every pocket by	REV_DEBT	Same as last Run
A number column with this many values or fewer is a category	12 values	Same as last Run
A text column with more values than this is too fine to cut by	50 values	Same as last Run

To change these, go back to Choose tests in the launcher and press Next.

The result tabs still show the last Run until you press Run. Each says "1 Control change waits for a Run" beside **Lines in use now**.

Step 21 · Close the workbook and press Run again

PocketBook

- ✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans
- ✓ **Set up**
10 columns read
- ✓ **Choose tests**
Where the book bleeds
- ✓ **Answer in workbook**
All answered
- ✓ **Run**
01:48 · 11 seconds

Run finished. Results are in the workbook.

Pockets worse and material 4 charge-offs, of 81	Charge-offs above their share \$3.09M in those 4 pockets
--	---

Open Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook.xlsx: start with Pockets. Split by REV_DEBT: each pocket halved at its own median. See the Split tab, and Pockets split by REV_DEBT. REV_DEBT isn't cut on its own while it splits.

[Run again](#) [Open at Start here](#)

Correct screen: "Run finished." The waiting count on Start here is back to 0.

Part C · Test new variables

A **new variable** is a column you think might tell good loans from bad, beyond what is already known. Here, revolving debt, with the FICO score held fixed so that REV_DEBT isn't just standing in for FICO.

Step 22 · Go back to Choose tests and pick Test new variables

Press **Choose tests** on the left, then **Test new variables** at the top right.

PocketBook

- ✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv - 8,000 loans
- ✓ **Set up**
10 columns read
- 3 Choose tests**
Test new variables
- 4 Answer in workbook
- 5 Run

What are you running?

Where the book bleeds **Test new variables**

Column	What it is	Outcome	Test it	Hold fixed
FICO	FICO score		☐	☐
ORIG_BAL	Booked amount		☐	☐
REV_DEBT	Amount or number		☐	☐
CHANNEL	Category - 3 values		☐	☐
ASSET_CLASS	Category - 4 values		☐	☐
BAD_FLAG	Outcome (yes/no)	•		
GCO_AMT	GCO dollars			
RANR_AMT	RANR dollars			
LOAN_NBR	Loan number (key)			
ORIG_DATE	Origination date			

Scout first
Or confirm a saved shortlist instead
Browse...

Install scikit-learn

One add-on is missing: scikit-learn, which finds new variables (scouting). Press Install scikit-learn, or confirm a saved shortlist instead.

GCO dollars: what a loan charged off, in dollars.
RANR dollars: what we kept from a loan after its losses, in dollars.
Scouting: the tree's first look at loans before the cutoff, to pick what to test.

Saved to Control, read-only.
Next: answer in the workbook →

Correct screen: the columns now read **Outcome**, **Test it** and **Hold fixed**. The rows stay in the same order. If a red button says **Install scikit-learn**, press it. **scikit-learn** is the free add-on that does the scouting.

Step 23 · Wait for scikit-learn

PocketBook

- ✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans
- ✓ **Set up**
10 columns read
- 3 Choose tests**
Test new variables
- 4 Answer in workbook
- 5 Run

What are you running?

Where the book bleeds | **Test new variables**

Column	What it is	Outcome	Test it	Hold fixed
FICO	FICO score		☐	☐
ORIG_BAL	Booked amount		☐	☐
REV_DEBT	Amount or number		☐	☐
CHANNEL	Category · 3 values		☐	☐
ASSET_CLASS	Category · 4 values		☐	☐
BAD_FLAG	Outcome (yes/no)	☒		
GCO_AMT	GCO dollars			
RANR_AMT	RANR dollars			
LOAN_NBR	Loan number (key)			
ORIG_DATE	Origination date			

Scout first | Or confirm a saved shortlist instead | **Browse...**

Tick at least one input to test.
GCO dollars: what a loan charged off, in dollars.
RANR dollars: what we kept from a loan after its losses, in dollars.

Installed scikit-learn. Everything PocketBook needs is here.

Saved to Control, read-only. | **Next: answer in the workbook →**

Correct screen: a line says it was installed. The box under the table asks you to tick at least one input.

Step 24 · Tick what to test and what to hold fixed

Tick **Test it** on ORIG_BAL, REV_DEBT, CHANNEL and ASSET_CLASS. Tick **Hold fixed** on FICO. Under the table it reads **Scout first**: that is the main path. **Or confirm a saved shortlist instead** is for a pre-spec written earlier; leave it.

PocketBook

- ✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv - 8,000 loans
- ✓ **Set up**
10 columns read
- 3 Choose tests**
Test new variables
- 4 Answer in workbook
- 5 Run

What are you running?

Where the book bleeds | **Test new variables**

Column	What it is	Outcome	Test it	Hold fixed
FICO	FICO score		☐	☒
ORIG_BAL	Booked amount		☒	☐
REV_DEBT	Amount or number		☒	☐
CHANNEL	Category - 3 values		☒	☐
ASSET_CLASS	Category - 4 values		☒	☐
BAD_FLAG	Outcome (yes/no)	🎯		
GCO_AMT	GCO dollars			
RANR_AMT	RANR dollars			
LOAN_NBR	Loan number (key)			
ORIG_DATE	Origination date			

Scout first
Or confirm a saved shortlist instead
[Browse...](#)

This will run: 4 inputs (REV_DEBT, ASSET_CLASS, CHANNEL, ORIG_BAL) against BAD_FLAG, with and without FICO held fixed: found on the loans made before the cutoff you pick on Control, then tested together and one by one on the rest.

GCO dollars: what a loan charged off, in dollars.
RANR dollars: what we kept from a loan after its losses, in dollars.

Installed scikit-learn. Everything PocketBook needs is here.

Saved to Control, read-only.

Next: answer in the workbook →

Correct screen: 4 inputs ... against BAD_FLAG, with and without FICO held fixed: found on the loans made before the cutoff you pick on Control, then tested together and one by one on the rest.

Step 25 · Press Next

PocketBook

✓ Extract

Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans

✓ Set up

10 columns read

✓ Choose tests

Test new variables

4 Answer in workbook

Fill in the shaded cells

5 Run

Answer in the workbook

Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook.xlsx is written beside the extract. Fill in the shaded cells, save and close it, then press Run.

Next: 1 answer needed before Run, on Control. Fill in the shaded cells, save, close, and press Run.

Open the workbook

Run

Correct screen: Next: 1 answer needed before Run, on Control. Your other Control answers carry over. Start here counts **1** answer needed, and the new kind of run as **1** change waiting for a Run, because the result tabs still show the last one:

PocketBook

Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans · 10 columns · last Run 2026-09-28 01:48

How this tab works

Where things stand

What the last Run found

The tabs

What is left before Run, counted live from Control and Columns as you fill them in.
Pockets worse and material at Control's lines, and the five largest.
Red tabs you fill in; black tabs hold results; grey tabs are the record.

WHERE THINGS STAND

Answers needed before Run	Odd values to answer	Changes waiting for a Run
1	0	1
Control and Columns	Columns · Treat as	Control · Status

1 change is waiting for a Run. What are you running?: Where the book bleeds → Finding and testing a new variable (launcher). The result tabs still show the last Run. Save, close, and press Run in the launcher.

WHAT THE LAST RUN FOUND

Pockets worse and material, charge-offs	Dollars above their share, in those	Pockets keeping less, worse and material
---	-------------------------------------	--

Open the workbook at Control. It shows only the questions this kind of run uses. One is new and shaded: **Loans made before this date find the candidates; the rest are held back**. That date is the **cutoff**. Beside it, under Worked out from the loans, PocketBook suggests one: 2024-11-01 (5,641 loans before, 2,359 after), the first of the month nearest 70% of the loans. Pick **The month start nearest 70% of the loans (suggested)**, or type a date of your own under **Or your own**. Save and close.

Control

How this tab works

Changes now

Needs a Run

Your answer

Worked out

Chosen in the launcher

Materiality levels

The professional calls. The top block changes results now, the second waits for a Run.

The result tabs read these answers with formulas. Change one and every reading, dollar figure, colour and verdict follows at once. The order of rows stays as the last Run left it. These decide which pockets exist and which test each one gets, so they take effect when you press Run again. Status says when an answer differs from what the last Run used. Risk from the list, or type a number under Or your own: a number there wins. A shaded answer still needs one. Comes to shows what the answer amounts to now. Worse at has a value worked out from this extract, from the groups being confirmed, shown beside the setting. It is never picked for you. What you're running and how the pockets are cut. Change them in the launcher's Choose tests, then press Next. They are shown here so a reviewer sees them. Material! on New variables compares each group's excess with the level you pick, low. The panel of levels counts pockets, so it is hidden on this run, which builds none.

Changes now

Needs a Run

Still needs an answer

Changes now - the result tabs follow as you change these

Setting

The smallest significant gap in a typical pocket (suggested)

Or your own

Comes to

Last Run used

Status

Worked out from the loans

How much worse than its comparison a pocket must be

95% sure

1.34x

1.34 (worked out from this book)

Worked out when you press Run

How sure a difference must be before it counts

1% of the book's total losses

\$107,354

95% sure

Smallest excess loss worth reporting

1% of the book's total losses

1% of the book's total losses

Needs a Run - takes effect when you press Run again

Setting

Your answer to

Or your own

Last Run used

Status

Worked out from the loans

How many bands a number column is cut into

5 bands (recommended)

5 bands

5 bands

Same as last Run

Where the band edges fall

Each band holds about the same number of loans (recommended)

Each band holds about the same number of loans

Same as last Run

Allowing for testing many pockets at once

Hold down the share of false finds (Benjamin-Hochberg) (recommended)

Hold down the share of false finds (Benjamin-Hochberg)

Same as last Run

Loans made before this date find the candidates, the rest are held back

suggested: 2024-11-01 (5,641 loans before, 2,359 after)

Chosen in the launcher - read-only here

To change these, go back to Choose tests in the launcher and press Next

Waiting for a Run

What are you running?

Finding and testing a new variable

Scout first

FICO

None

BAD_FLAG

REV_DEBT, ASSET_CLASS, CHANNEL, ORIG_BAL

FICO

Cut into bands

12 values

50 values

Segment by

12 values

50 values

Split every pocket by

12 values

50 values

Tested against

12 values

50 values

Inputs tested

12 values

50 values

Held back

12 values

50 values

Saved shortlist (pre-spec file)

12 values

50 values

A number column with this many values or fewer is a category

12 values

50 values

A text column with more values than this is too fine to cut by

12 values

50 values

Step 26 · Press Run

On 8,000 loans it took 22 seconds. PocketBook builds the tree on the loans made before 2024-11-01, writes the pre-spec Consumer book Q3 - pre-spec.yaml beside the workbook, and only then reads the held-back loans: first to check the tree on them, then to test the shortlist.

PocketBook

Extract

Consumer book Q3.csv - 8,000 loans

Set up

10 columns read

Choose tests

Test new variables

Answer in workbook

All answered

Run

01:48 · 22 seconds

Run finished. Results are in the workbook.

REV_DEBT groups worse than 11,000 - 14,999

1 of 2

on the holdout, 95% sure

Their share of bad loans

54%

on the holdout

Follows the pre-spec

Written now

by this Run's scouting

Open Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook.xlsx: start with New variables.

Ran on 8,000 loans from Consumer book Q3.csv. What was run: Finding and testing a new variable: scout first.

Run again

Open at Start here

Correct screen: the first tile names the column and its reference group (the middle group, which every other is compared with): **1 of 2** REV_DEBT groups worse, on the held-back loans. The last tile says the pre-spec was **written now, by this Run's scouting**. It can't differ from itself, so it doesn't say "Yes". Under the tiles: start with New variables.

page 25 of 31

Step 27 · Read Start here

PocketBook

Consumer book Q3.csv · 8,000 loans · 10 columns · last Run 2026-09-28 01:48

How this tab works

Where things stand

What is left before Run, counted live from Control and Columns as you fill them in.

What the last Run found

Each group of the tested column on the holdout, against the reference group. Significant? follows the confidence on Control; the rest is as of the last Run.

The tabs

Red tabs you fill in; black tabs hold results; grey tabs are the record.

WHERE THINGS STAND

Answers needed before Run	Odd values to answer	Changes waiting for a Run
0	0	0
Control and Columns	Columns · Treat as	Control · Status

WHAT THE LAST RUN FOUND

Groups worse than 11,000 - 14,999, on the holdout	Their share of the holdout's bad loans	Loans tested	Follows the pre-spec
1 of 2	54%	5,640 found · 2,359 held back	Written now: by this Run's scouting

Group of REV_DEBT	Loans	Bad rate	× 11,000 - 14,999's odds, FICO held fixed	p-value	Significant?	Share of bad loans
0 - 10,999	1,116	5.20%	1.20×	45.9%	No	32%
11,000 - 14,999 (reference)	541	4.81%	1.00×			14%
15,000 - 48,522	702	13.96%	2.68×	under 0.01%	Yes, worse	54%

Found beside confirmed, with and without the columns held fixed, and how it's worked out: the New variables tab.

Correct screen: one row per REV_DEBT group on the held-back loans. 15,000 and up is **Yes, worse:** 2.68 times the odds of going bad with FICO held fixed (the column heading says so), holding 54% of the bad loans.

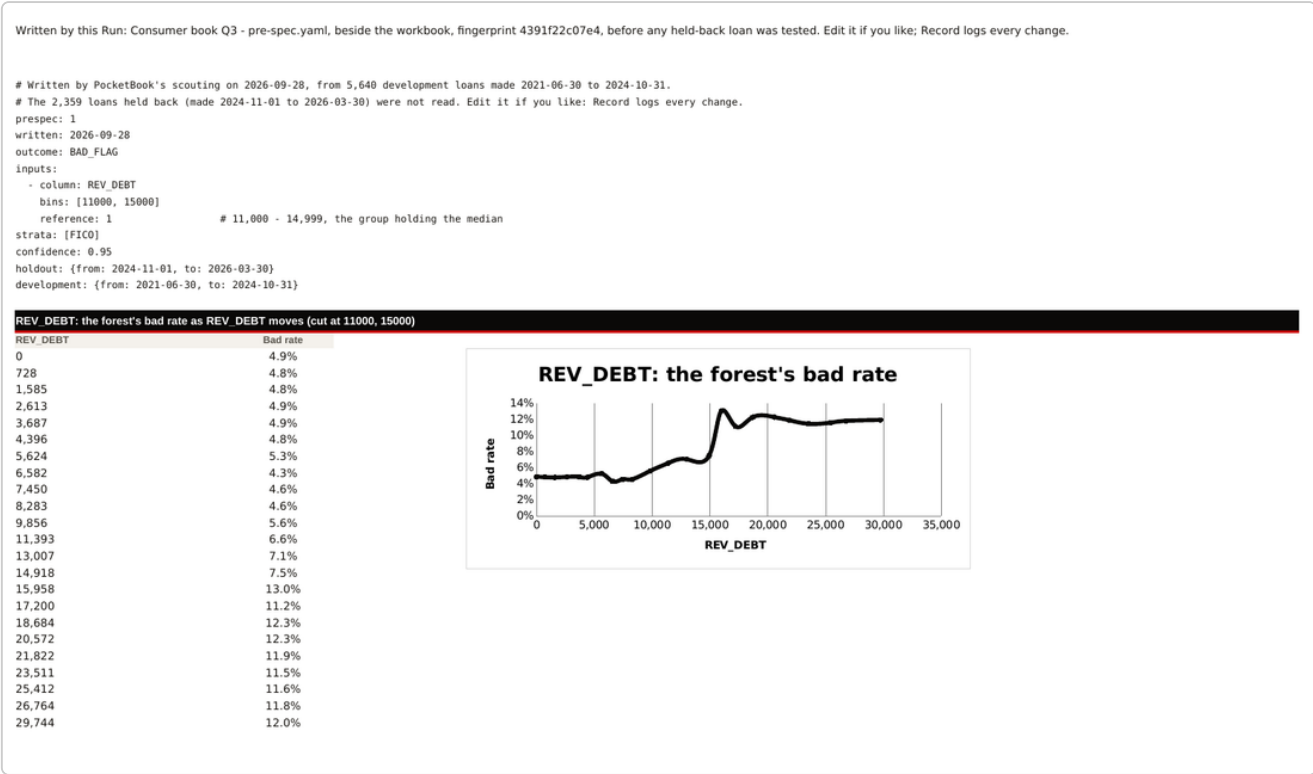
Step 28 · Read Scouting

Which candidates the book leans on, ranked, on the development loans only.

Scouting				
Which of the 4 candidates does the book lean on, and where does each one bend? On the development loans only.				
How this tab works				
What it is	Scouting: which of the 4 candidates the book leans on, and where each one bends. It nominates; it never confirms (statistics.md B7). The confirmation is the New variables tab, on loans scouting never read.			
Found on	5,640 development loans made 2021-06-30 to 2024-10-31, 437 of them bad: every loan made before the cutoff on Control, 2024-11-01. The 2,359 loans made on or after it are held back. Only their dates were read to rank the candidates and cut their bins; their outcomes and every other value were read only once the pre-spec was written, to check the tree on them (the New variables tab). Left out: 1 with no readable outcome.			
Candidates	The columns ticked Test it in the launcher, and every new column made on Columns (one column divided by another), each fed in as a column in its own right. A category is given one number per value, in the order of its values.			
The forest	A random forest: 200 trees, each leaf at least 40 loans, seed 7, grown by scikit-learn 1.9.1. Each tree splits the loans wherever a cut best separates bad from good, and the forest averages their votes. It writes no formula and assumes no shape. The same extract gives the same forest; another version of scikit-learn may not.			
Importance	How far the forest's AUC drops when the column is shuffled, on loans it did not train on. AUC is the chance a random bad loan scores above a random good one; 0.5 is a coin flip. The development loans are cut into 3 runs by date; each run is scored by a forest grown on the other two, with 5 shuffles of each column, and the drops are averaged. The forest's own AUC is 0.669. It is a ranking: no direction, no size and no range, and it leans towards columns with many distinct values.			
With and without	Importance is from a forest given the candidates alone. The next column is from a forest given FICO as well (AUC 0.687): a candidate that drops there was mostly telling you FICO. Their own importance is under the table.			
Noise floor	0.0249: the largest importance any candidate reached in the same forests grown on the development loans with their outcomes shuffled among them, so that no column could matter (20 tries). It is what a column scores by chance.			
Proposed?	Yes for a number column whose importance is above the noise floor, with the held-fixed columns in the forest or without them, and whose shape bends somewhere to cut. A category is ranked and not proposed: the pre-spec cuts a number at its bins.			
Suggested bins	From the shape: the forest's bad rate with the column set to one value for every loan (partial dependence, on 1,000 development loans drawn by seed), over the column's own percentiles, from a forest grown on every development loan with FICO in it. A cut goes where the curve steps by at least 25% of its average, largest step first, each group holding at least 2% of the loans, at most 6 groups. Inside each step the edge sits where the forest itself split the column most, rounded to two figures. The shapes are under the table.			
Reference	The group holding the development loans' median value: the ordinary case, which every other group is compared with.			
Correlated with	Candidates, and held-fixed number columns, whose values rise and fall together with this one: a rank correlation (Spearman's) of 0.7 or more either way, on the development loans with both. Importance splits between such columns, and the shape of one can borrow the other's.			
The pre-spec	PocketBook writes the pre-spec from the proposed candidates beside the workbook, when there is none, and the confirmation reads it. One that is there already is confirmed as it stands: an edit is yours to make, and Record logs it. The file is under the table.			
As of	The last Run, 2026-09-28 01:48. Nothing here follows Control until the next Run.			
Outcome	Candidates · proposed	Held fixed	Noise floor	Development loans
BAD_FLAG	4 · 1 proposed	FICO	0.0249	5,640 · 437 bad
Worked out at the last Run, 2026-09-28 01:48, on the development loans. Ranked by the larger of the two importances.				
Candidate	Rank	Importance	FICO held fixed	Suggested bins
REV_DEBT	1	0.1474	0.0757	0 - 10,999; 11,000 - 14,999; 15,000 - 47,478
CHANNEL	2	0.0109	0.0047	Each value
ASSET_CLASS	3	0.0083	0.0073	Each value
ORIG_BAL	4	0.0018	-0.0012	5,024 - 6,299; 6,300 - 59,984
Reference				
11,000 - 14,999				
Correlated with				
6,300 - 59,984				
Proposed?				
Yes				
Why				
clears the noise floor				
No				
a category				
No				
a category				
No				
below the noise floor				
Held fixed, for comparison: their own importance with the candidates				
Column	Importance			
FICO	0.0558			

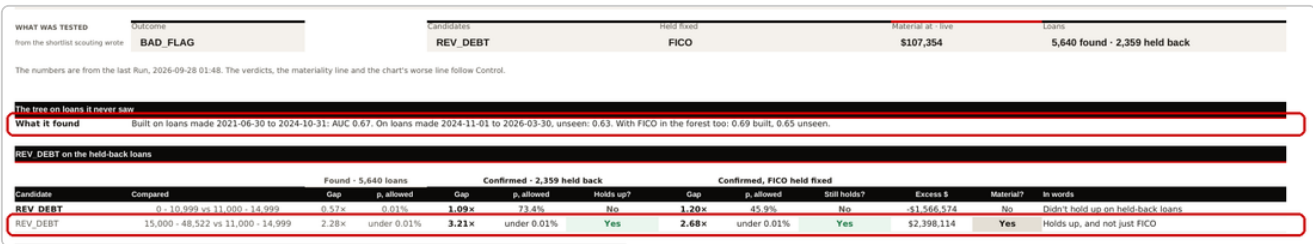
Correct screen: REV_DEBT first, **Proposed? Yes**, above the **noise floor** (what a column scores by pure chance). CHANNEL and ASSET_CLASS are categories, ranked but not proposed. ORIG_BAL is below the floor.

Further down, the pre-spec as written, and REV_DEBT's curve with the suggested cuts. Printed, the pre-spec's page has no table heading over it:



Step 29 • Read New variables

Does REV_DEBT still tell good loans from bad on loans it was never found on, and once FICO is held fixed?



Correct screen: first, one line: **the tree on loans it never saw**. Built on loans made up to 2024-10-31 its AUC was 0.67; on the loans made from 2024-11-01, which it never saw, 0.63 (0.69 and 0.65 with FICO in the tree too). It still ranks later loans nearly as well, so it learnt the book, not those years.

When scouting proposes two columns or more, the next table puts them all in one regression on the held-back loans: each group's odds ratio net of the other columns, and **Adds?**, whether each column tells you something the others don't. Here scouting proposed REV_DEBT alone, so there is nothing to read it net of, and that table isn't drawn.

Then REV_DEBT on its own. 15,000 and up: **Holds up? Yes** and **Still holds? Yes** (with FICO held fixed), **Material? Yes**. Under 11,000: found on development, but it **didn't hold up** on the held-back loans.

Step 30 • Read Record

Record	
What ran, whether it adds up, what was left out, and every Run. For the reviewer.	
How this tab works	
What it holds	What the last Run was, whether it adds up, which tests it used, what it left out, and every Run and refusal. Nothing here is a result.
Settings	Each Control setting: the answer in use now, and what the last Run used. A setting changed since the Run is shaded; the result is shaded.
Every Run	Newest first. Each entry is what that Run used, and a refusal says what it was waiting for.
This Run	
Item	Detail
Extract	Consumer book Q3.csv
Loans run	8,000
What was run	Finding and testing a new variable: scout first
Record of this run	Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook - what ran.yaml, beside this workbook: every setting the run used, kept for the file. It is replaced by the next Run.
Origination dates	2021-06-30 to 2026-03-30 (8,000 loans; 0 without a readable date)
Band edges used: FICO	654; 686; 712; 746 (5 bands)
Scouting	4 candidates on 5,640 development loans made 2021-06-30 to 2024-10-31; 1 proposed: REV_DEBT. See the Scouting tab.
Scouting held back	2,359 loans made 2024-11-01 to 2026-03-30: none of their outcomes or values was read by scouting.
Scouting's pre-spec	Written by this Run: Consumer book Q3 - pre-spec.yaml, beside the workbook, fingerprint 4391f22c07e4, before any held-back loan was tested. Edit it if you like; Record logs every change.
Scouting out of time	Built on loans made 2021-06-30 to 2024-10-31: AUC 0.67. On loans made 2024-11-01 to 2026-03-30, unseen: 0.63. With FICO in the forest too: 0.69 built, 0.65 unseen.
Pre-spec commit	not in a git repository, so not committed: a pre-spec only counts once it is committed
Pre-spec fingerprint	4391f22c07e4: the first 12 characters of the file's SHA-256, so any change to it shows
What the pre-spec says	written: 2026-09-28 outcome: BAD_FLAG inputs: 1 1. column: REV_DEBT 1. bins: 11,000, 15,000 (groups: 0 - 10,999; 11,000 - 14,999; 15,000 - 48,522) 1. reference: 11,000 - 14,999 strata: FICO confidence: 0.95 holdout: 2024-11-01 to 2026-03-30 development: 2021-06-30 to 2024-10-31
Warning	This run doesn't count as the pre-specified one until the pre-spec is committed, unchanged.
Differs from the pre-spec	nowhere: this run used what it says
Holdout	2,359 of this extract's loans were made in the holdout (2024-11-01 to 2026-03-30), the first on 2024-11-01 and the last on 2026-03-30. This run touched the holdout.
Confirmatory test	Development 2021-06-30 to 2024-10-31: 5,640 loans, 437 bad; holdout 2024-11-01 to 2026-03-30: 2,359 loans, 182 bad. See the New variables tab. Left out of this test only (the loan counts on Record include them): 1 with no readable outcome.
Runs that touched the holdout	1 on Record's Every Run, this one included
This pre-spec's held-back runs	In order: this run (4391f22c07e4).

Correct screen: Scouting out of time, the tree's line again; the pre-spec's fingerprint (a short code that changes if the file changes by even one character); and one run that touched the held-back loans. It read them twice, for the tree's check and for the test, and counts once. (The pre-spec's own row, which names where the file is, is left out of this picture.)

Step 31 · Edit the pre-spec after the held-back run, and Run again

Open Consumer book Q3 - pre-spec.yaml in Notepad. Change bins: [11000, 15000] to bins: [10000, 16000]. Save. Press **Run again**.

This is what the pre-spec exists to catch: changing the test after seeing the answer. PocketBook runs it, and labels it.

PocketBook

✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv ·
8,000 loans

✓ **Set up**
10 columns read

✓ **Choose tests**
Test new variables

✓ **Answer in workbook**
All answered

✓ **Run**
01:48 · 20 seconds

Run finished. Results are in the workbook.

REV_DEBT groups
worse than 10,000 -
15,999
1 of 2
on the holdout, 95%
sure

Their share of bad loans
45%
on the holdout

Follows the pre-spec
Changed
after a held-back run:
see Record

Open Consumer book Q3 - PocketBook.xlsx: start with New variables.
Changed pre-spec: Consumer book Q3 - pre-spec.yaml changed after the held-back
run of 2026-09-28 01:48: fingerprint 4391f22c07e4 then, b34a2a3b06f9 now. This run
is on the changed pre-spec.

Run again

Open at Start here

Correct screen: the last tile says **Changed, after a held-back run**, in red, and the line under the tiles gives the date of the earlier run and both fingerprints. On Record, under **This Run**, a red **Warning** says the same, and two runs have now touched the held-back loans:

Pre-spec commit	not in a git repository, so not committed: a pre-spec only counts once it is committed
Pre-spec fingerprint	b34a2a3b06f9: the first 12 characters of the file's SHA-256, so any change to it shows
What the pre-spec says	written: 2026-09-28
	outcome: BAD_FLAG
	inputs: 1
	1. column: REV_DEBT
	1. bins: 10,000, 16,000 (groups: 0 - 9,999; 10,000 - 15,999; 16,000 - 48,522)
	1. reference: 10,000 - 15,999
	strata: FICO
	confidence: 0.95
	holdout: 2024-11-01 to 2026-03-30
	development: 2021-06-30 to 2024-10-31
Warning	This run doesn't count as the pre-specified one until the pre-spec is committed, unchanged.
Warning	Changed pre-spec: Consumer book Q3 - pre-spec.yaml changed after the held-back run of 2026-09-28 01:48: fingerprint 4391f22c07e4 then, b34a2a3b06f9 now. This run is on the changed pre-spec.
Differs from the pre-spec	nowhere: this run used what it says
Holdout	2,359 of this extract's loans were made in the holdout (2024-11-01 to 2026-03-30), the first on 2024-11-01 and the last on 2026-03-30. This run touched the holdout.
Confirmatory test	Development 2021-06-30 to 2024-10-31: 5,640 loans, 437 bad; holdout 2024-11-01 to 2026-03-30: 2,359 loans, 182 bad. See the New variables tab. Left out of this test only (the loan counts on Record include them): 1 with no readable outcome.
Runs that touched the holdout	2 on Record's Every Run, this one included
This pre-spec's held-back runs	In order: 2026-09-28 01:48 (4391f22c07e4); this run (b34a2a3b06f9, changed).

When PocketBook says no

What you did	What the window says	What to do
Opened it before the add-ons were installed	Black bar: "Three add-ons are missing ..." (Step 1)	Press Install now . If it fails, press Copy for IT and send them the note.
Pressed Run before answering (Step 7)	"9 answers needed before Run", each with its cell	Press Open at on each, answer, save, close, Run.
Left the workbook open in Excel (Step 11)	Pink bar: "The workbook is open in Excel." Run is grey.	Save and close it. The bar goes by itself.
Picked Test new variables without scikit-learn (Step 22)	"One add-on is missing: scikit-learn ..."	Press Install scikit-learn , or confirm a saved shortlist instead.
The grids didn't add up (Step 32, below)	"Run stopped: the grids didn't add up to the book, so nothing was written."	Nothing you answered caused it. Send the file named on the screen.

Step 32 · What a stopped Run looks like

This can't be made to happen from the screens. On the walk it was forced, to see what the window says.

PocketBook

✓ **Extract**
Consumer book Q3.csv ·
8,000 loans

✓ **Set up**
10 columns read

✓ **Choose tests**
Where the book bleeds

! **Answer in workbook**
Run stopped

5 **Run**

Run stopped

Nothing was written. Your answers so far are kept.

Run stopped: the grids didn't add up to the book, so nothing was written. grid fico x channel / REV_DEBT: rows adds up to 7999 across the cells, but the book says 8000.

That is a fault in PocketBook, not in your answers. The details are in /srv/analyst/pocketbook/last-error.txt; send that file over to get it fixed.

Open the workbook

Run

Correct screen: "Run stopped", not "answers needed". The message says the grids didn't add up to the book, that nothing was written, and where the details are.